



What is a 3G phone?

A 3G phone is one that can use 3G networks. 3G is an abbreviation for 'third generation cellular technology', the 'first generation' having been analogue cellular, and the 'second generation' being today's digital cellular networks. 3G supports very high-speed data services over a cellular network. In fact, multimedia 3G networks transmit wireless data up to 2 Mbps. 3G mobile phones offer high-speed Internet connectivity using Universal Mobile Telecommunications System—the technology of choice for third-generation wireless service delivery.

Why do we need 3G phones?

3G will support bandwidth-hungry applications such as full-motion video, video-conferencing and full Internet access.

Where has 3G been deployed?

3G has been deployed in all the developed nations, as well as in Pakistan, Vietnam, Thailand, and several other countries. India is still awaiting the TRAI's recommendations on 3G.

Who was responsible for the development of 3G?

3G is an initiative of the International Telecommunications Union (ITU). The World Administrative Conference (WAC) assigned 230 MHz of spectrum at 2 GHz for multimedia 3G networks.

When did 3G first appear on the scene?

3G network trials started in Japan in 2001.

How do 3G-enabled devices operate?

3G-enabled devices send and receive radio signals to and from base stations. The base stations are low-power radio transmitters—each providing coverage to a cell. Cells need to overlap to enable seamless coverage.

pattern of randomly-phased harmonics. Bocko and Ignjatovic tweaked a few harmonics to shift out of the pattern and then used those shifts to convey a 20-kilobit speech message.

Their patented idea is to incorporate a software decoder in file-sharing applications which encourage mass copying and are the bane of the music industry.

The decoder would detect the telltale phase shifts and convert them into the warning message, causing them to boom out through loudspeakers or headphones, *New Scientist* reports.

For legitimate listeners, the digital shifts are so small that there is no difference in the perception of the music. This may not always be the case, though—there is speculation that tracks might skip at the point of insertion of the message.

Earlier attempts by

GIMME THE MEGAPIXELS!

Digicams A Must-buy For 2005

A recent poll by GMI (Global Market Insite, Inc, headquartered in Washington state, USA) focusing on new personal technology purchasing patterns revealed that new technology's appeal is strong worldwide. The GMIPoll (www.gmipoll.com), which surveyed 20,000 consumers in 20 countries, found that 59 per cent have a need for more technology.

In all countries except for the US, the PC has overtaken TV as the one technology that people cannot live without. The GMIPoll found that 75 per cent of consumers ranked

home printing and DVR technology.

Asked what technology they most frequently upgrade, 63 per cent cited mobile phones. The readiness to upgrade one's mobile phone seems strongest in Asia and South America. Almost 75 per cent of consumers in India and China said they upgraded their phone more often than any other technology.

The survey suggests that in the West, word of mouth is the biggest influence on customers' purchasing choices. But in the fastest-growing economies of Asia, such as India and China, advertising came in as the number one influencer, with 70 per cent citing it.

BLOGGING CUM SOCIAL NETWORKING

Yahoo! Launches New Service

Yahoo! has introduced a new service that blends several of its site's popular features with two of the Internet's fastest growing activities—blogging and social networking. The hybrid service, called 'Yahoo 360', was launched March 29. Yahoo! has been testing the service with a small group of employees, some of whom have been working on the project since last year.

The service is designed to enable Yahoo's users to pull content from the Web site's discussion groups, online photo albums and review sections, and plug them into their own blogs. Yahoo! will also make it easy for the service's users to connect with others who share common interests and friends—the practice known as social networking. ■

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researchers to bury anti-piracy signals in copyrighted music and films have run into countermeasures by hackers, who filter out the message. Earlier attempts also almost always resulted in compatibility problems with players—the track would either skip, or not play at all.

their PC as their must-have technology, compared to 67 per cent for TV, and the mobile phone came in a close third with 54 per cent.

Looking at what new technology consumers are most likely to purchase in 2005, overall the GMIPoll found that digital cameras came out tops, with nearly 40 per cent choosing digital cameras over wireless,